

Rummy

Card Deck · 2 to 6 players · about 30 minutes

House rules written for The Game Room. These are the common rules; plenty of tables play their own variations, so agree on any before you start.

Setup

Deal 10 cards each with 2 players, 7 each with 3 or 4, and 6 each with 5 or 6. Turn the next card face up to start the discard pile; the rest is the stock.

How to play

On your turn, take the top card of the stock or the discard pile. You may then lay melds face up in front of you: three or four cards of the same rank (a set), or three or more cards in sequence in one suit (a run; ace is low). You may also lay off single cards onto any meld already on the table. End your turn by discarding one card.

If the stock runs out, turn the discard pile over, without shuffling, to make a new stock.

Going out and scoring

The first player to get rid of every card goes out and wins the hand; the last card may be a discard or part of a meld. The winner scores the cards left in everyone else's hands: face cards 10, aces 1, everything else its face value. First to 100 wins.

Gin Rummy, for two

Deal 10 cards each. Turn the next card face up to start the discard pile; the rest is the stock.

On your turn, take the top card of the stock or the discard pile, then discard one card. You are building melds: three or four cards of the same rank, or three or more cards in sequence in one suit (ace is low). Cards outside melds are deadwood: face cards count 10, aces 1, others face value.

When your deadwood totals 10 or less you may knock: lay out your melds and deadwood. Your opponent lays out theirs and may add cards to your melds. If your deadwood is lower, you score the difference.

Going gin (no deadwood) scores the difference plus 25, and your opponent may not add to your melds.

If the opponent's deadwood is equal or lower, they score the difference plus 25. First to 100 wins.